

“The Democratic Party **Gone to Smash**. The Work is done. The irrepressible conflict has **rent the Democratic Party asunder.**”

CHICAGO DEMOCRAT, MAY 1, 1860

A chance for compromise?

No candidate captured a majority of the popular vote, and neither Lincoln nor Breckinridge received much more than a bare majority in his region. Lincoln’s opponents together outpolled him by nearly a million votes. In the South, Breckinridge lost the popular vote in the slave states to a combined opposition, which received 55 percent of the total Southern vote. The upper South wanted compromise, not conflict.

